



Gnanambal Samedha Kalahasteeswarar Koil

This temple is located in Kakkalni Village on Eastern end of Agraharam, on way to Thevur, via Retta madagadi.



Currently pooja activities are carried out by Shri Manikandan Kurukkal (alias Sridhar). He is from 5th generation in his family taking care of poojas here. From this it is estimated that this temple is 400+ years old. It is learnt by him from his grandparents, this temple is one among 48 Shiva temples built by our Chozha King. He conducted Kumbabishekam at Thiruvarur Thyagaraja swamy temple. Post kumbabishekam of Thiruvarur temple in mandala period of 48 days, every day kumbabishekam to each of these 48 Shiva temples were conducted. This temple at our village is one among them.

Let us get in to, few important notes about this temple –

1. Picture 1 above shows entrance to this temple. On the top of this entrance you can see idol Lord Shiva & Goddess Parvathi along with Lord Murugan & Lord Ganapathy
2. Picture 2 above shows side view of this temple, where you can see gopuram above Lord Shiva. On the right, you see wall of Mandapam in front of Lord Shiva sannidhanam, Here you can also see a small structure attached to wall of Lord Shiva Sannadhi. This is Lord Dakshinamoorthy Sannidhi.
3. Right in front of main entrance is Gnanambal Sannidhi. As per aagama sasthanam, when you visit Lord Shiva temple, 1st you should take darshan of Lord Ganapathy, then have darshan of Ambal before we take darshan of Lord Shiva.



4. Matching to above aagama sasthanam this temple is built. Close to Lord Dakshinamoorthy Sannadhi, we have Lord Ganapathy Sannadhi, as you see in picture -3. As soon as you enter temple when you see to your left, you can darshan of Lord Ganapathy, climb steps & right in front you take darshan of ambal & when you turn to your left you take darshan of lord shiva. On your right you can have darshan of Nandi.

Ganambal is very powerful deity, you sincerely pray with devotion, she fulfils your prayer. This is experienced by few donors of current younger generation in this group.

5. In outer praharam when visit lord ganapathy sannadhi, to your right you can have darshan of lord Dakshinamoorthy
6. You go further then, just behind Lord shiva sannidhanam is Lord Kasi Viswanathar with goddess Visalakshi. This idol was brought by Koorakattu family from Kasi & installed here. Here lord shiva is facing West. It is said you take darshan of lord shiva facing west you attain path to moksha. In our village it is unique to have lord shiva facing east as well west
7. You move further, you can have darshan of Lord subramanya (Murugan). Speciality here peacock on which lord murugan is seated is facing north. It is said, peacock facing north are Devargal group &



one facing south is Asurargal group.

8. You move further, you can have darshan of Chandikeswarar, just close to Dhara outlet from lord shiva sannidhanam.
9. You move further, you come to well inside the temple from where water is used for temple activities. To know more about this well see note 13 below as well how this village got the name "Kakkalani"
10. Just in front of same is Navagraha sannadhi.

11. Adjacent to Navagraha sannadhi, there are 3 idols – Lord Suryan, Lord saneeswaran and Lord Kalabhairavar
12. Another important feature is, both well inside temple and Kadugayar river behind the temple are to the North east of main idol in temple. As per vastu water flowing towards North east is always good. This is another positive feature of this temple placement.
13. **Importance of this temple, adjacent Mazhai Marriamman temple & story about how this village got the name “Kakkalani”**

As advised by devas the negatively afflicted (dosham petra) Rahul and Ketu worshiped Lord Shiva at SriKalahasti and got salvation. Devas who worshiped Lord Shiva obtained nectar and wisdom told Rahu and Ketu that if they worship Lord Shiva they would be granted the status of planets and placed alongside the other seven planets to form Navgrahas.

As Rahu and Ketu worshiped Lord Shiva in our village, Lord Shiva and Goddess Parvati were sacredly named as SriGnanambika samedas SriKalahastheeswarar who is bestowing graces. Inside prakaram Sri Visalakshi Vishvanathar temple is also there.

While Rahu, Ketu and Sanishwara Bhagavan were Worshipping Lord Shiva, Lord Shiva appeared before them and told them to perform puja with Gangai water for redemption of sins and also free this village from shortage of water. Even though there were a lot of hurdles to bring Gangai water Lord Surya with the help of our village Goddess Mariamman Ambal brought Ganges water through the sky and poured Ganges water into a well (Kenni) dug inside the temple and then pujas were performed. As gangai water was brought and filled in to the well this village was named as Gangaikenni which over a period of time changed to Kakkazhani.

As our village Goddess Sri Mariamman Ambal helped Lord Surya in bringing Ganges water named as Mazhai Mariamman, the deity of fertility and rain, guardian against evil energies.